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INTERIM REVISION OF
Fed. Spec. UU-F-350a
July 14, 1959

INTERIM FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

FILE BACKER, PAPER

This Interim Federal Specification was developed by the Standardization Division, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, Washington, D.C., 20406, based upon currently available technical information. It is recommended that Federal agencies use it in procurement and forward recommendations for changes to the preparing activity at the address shown above.

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this Interim Federal Specification as a valid exception to Federal Specification UU-F-350a, dated July 14, 1959.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers a letter size paper file backer, equipped with a prong type paper fastener for holding paper. The file backer shall be of one type.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

Federal Specifications:

PPP-B-636 - Box, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-676 - Boxes, Setup.

Federal Standard:

Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civilian Agencies).

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D.C. 20402.)

(Single copies of this specification and other Federal Specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, D.C., Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles and Seattle, Wash.)

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

FSC 7510

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2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply:

Technical Association of the Pulp and Paper Industry (TAPPI) Test Methods:

T 401 m - 60 - Fiber analysis of paper and paperboard.
T 402 os - 49 - Conditioning paper and paperboard for testing.
T 410 os - 61 - Basis weight of paper and paperboard.
T 411 os - 44 - Thickness and density of paper.
T 414 ts - 65 - Internal tearing resistance of paper.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Technical Association of the Pulp and Paper Industry, 360 Lexington Avenue, New York, New York 10017.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material. Materials used in the manufacture of paper file backers shall comply with the physical characteristics and other requirements specified herein, and shall be suitable for the application for which they are utilized.

3.1.1 Paper Stock. The paper stock of the file backer shall be 100 percent sulfate pulp (natural color), conforming to the physical properties specified in Table I.

TABLE I. Physical properties

Basis weight (24 x 36 inches - 500) pounds	147 ± 5 percent
Thickness, inch	0.011 ± .0005 inch
Tearing resistance, gram	
Machine Direction	260
Cross Machine Direction	360

3.2 Paper fastener. The paper fastener shall be made of a metal suitable for the purpose intended, and shall meet the test requirements specified in 4.4.2. without evidence of fracture. The prongs shall be attached to, or a continuation of, each end of the base. The metal shall be 0.012 inch thick, plus or minus 0.001 inch.

3.3 Design and construction. The paper file backer shall be designed to hold letter-size paper. The grain of the paper backer shall run parallel with the largest dimension. The edges of the file backer shall be shear cut and square within the dimensional tolerance. The paper fastener shall be permanently affixed to the paper backer and centered 11/16 inch, plus or minus 1/16 inch, from the top of the file backer, on the 8-1/2 inch side.

3.4 Dimensions

3.4.1 Paper Backer. The file backer shall be 8-1/2 by 11 inches. A plus or minus tolerance of 1/16 inch shall be permitted.

3.4.2 Paper fastener. The base length of the paper fastener shall be 2-3/4 inches. The prongs length shall be 1-1/2 inches, plus or minus 1/16 inch, and shall have a width of not less than 3/16 inch or more than 7/32 inch.

3.5 Finish. The paper fastener shall be coated with lacquer, or backed enamel, or tinned.

3.6 Workmanship. The paper file backer shall be free from defect which may affect serviceability or appearance, and the finish shall be smooth and uniform. The paper fastener shall be free from burrs, sharp or rough edges or corners which may be a hazard to the user or damage the file paper.

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4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Inspection of materials. The supplier is responsible for assuring that materials conform to the physical properties specified in this specification.

4.2 Sampling

4.2.1 Size of lot. All file backers presented for inspection at one time shall be considered a lot for the purpose of examinations and test.

4.2.2 Sampling and inspection for acceptance. Sampling and inspection for acceptance shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise specified.

4.2.3 Sampling for visual and dimensional examination. Random sample of file backers shall be taken from each lot in accordance with MIL-STD-105. A sample unit shall be one file backer. The file backer shall be examined for defects listed in table II. The Inspection Level shall be S-2, and the Acceptable Quality Level (AQL) shall be 2.5 defects per hundred units.

4.2.4 Sampling for end item tests. Random sample of file backers shall be taken from each lot in accordance with MIL-STD-105. A sample unit for each test shall be one file backer, and shall be tested as specified in 4.4. The inspection level shall be S-3, and the AQL shall be 2.5 defects per hundred units.

4.2.5 Sampling for preparation for delivery requirements. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery at one time. The lot shall be all of the containers offered for delivery at one time. The inspection level shall be S-4, and the AQL shall be 6.5 defects per hundred units.

4.3 Examination

4.3.1 Visual and dimensional examination. Samples taken in accordance with 4.2.3 shall be examined for defects listed in table II. Any file backer in the sample having one or more defects shall be rejected. If the number of defective units in the sample exceeds the acceptance number for that sample, the entire lot shall be rejected.

TABLE II. Visual and dimensional examination

Examine	Defects
File Backer	Grain not parallel with largest dimension. Edges torn, corners split or broken. File backer not clean, or welted, lumpy, curled or wavy. File backer not square cut.
Paper fastener	Not securely and permanently affixed to file backer and centered as specified. Not coated as specified. Not free of burrs, rough edges or corners.
Dimension	Dimensions of file backer or paper fastener not as specified or within tolerance.

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4.3.2 Examination of preparation for delivery. Samples selected in accordance with 4.2.5 shall be examined for defects listed in table III to determine that packaging, packing, and marking requirements of section 5 of this specification are complied with.

TABLE III. Examination of preparation for delivery

Examination	Defect
Markings, exterior and interior	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; of improper size, location, sequence, or method application.
Materials	Component missing or damaged.
Contents	More or less than required.

4.3.2.1 Examination for closure and strapping of shipping containers. When shipping containers are required to be in accordance with PPP-B-636, examination for defects in closure and strapping shall be in accordance with the appendix of that specification.

4.4 Tests

4.4.1 Tests for Material. Samples obtained in accordance with 4.2.4 shall be subjected to the following tests. Failure to pass the test(s) shall be considered cause for rejection of the lot, as not meeting the material requirements of this specification.

4.4.1.2 Paper. The physical properties of the paper shall be conditioned and tested in accordance with the applicable TAPPI test methods listed in table IV , to assure compliance with requirements listed in 3.1.1. All samples shall be conditioned and tested under uniform atmospheric conditions as detailed in TAPPI method T 402os-49.

TABLE IV. Applicable test methods (paper)

Physical Properties	TAPPI test methods
Fiber analysis of paper and paperboard	T 401 m - 60
Conditioning of paper and paperboard testing	T 402 os - 49
Basis weight	T 410 os - 61
Thickness, inch	T 411 os - 44
Tearing resistance	T 414 ts - 65

4.4.2 Tests (paper fastener). The paper fastener of the sample file backers selected in accordance with 4.2.4 shall be subjected to the following cold bend tests. The prongs shall show no evidence of fracture at any point when tests are completed. Any sample unit failing one or more test(s) shall be considered defective. If the number of defective paper fasteners exceeds the acceptance number for the sample, the lot represented by the sample shall be rejected.

4.4.2.1 Cold bend test (1). Insert the prongs through the perforation of one sheet of paper and bend prongs down to the base (prong position when fastener is secured), and back to the 90 degree arc position, a minimum of 20 times.

4.4.2.1.1. Cold bend test (2). Insert the prongs through the perforation of sheets of paper having a total thickness of not less than half the capacity of the fastener; bend prongs down flat to closed position and back to the 90 degrees arc position a minimum of 50 times.

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5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A, B or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A and B. One hundred file backers shall be packaged in a box conforming to PPP-B-676.

5.1.2 Level C. File backers shall be packaged in accordance with the suppliers commercial practice.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A. Five unit packages of file backers shall be packed in a box conforming to PPP-B-636, class weather-resistant. The box shall be closed, water-proofed, and strapped in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.2.2 Level B. Five unit packages of file backers shall be packed in a box conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic. Boxes shall be closed in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.2.3 Level C. File backers shall be packed to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at destination at the lowest rates, in containers complying with the rules and regulations applicable to the mode of transportation.

5.3 Marking. In addition to the markings required by the contractor or order the unit packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123 or MIL-STD-129 as applicable.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The file backers are intended for filing papers, when the protection of a file folder is not required.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement document:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.

(b) Both the level of packaging and the level of packing required (see 5).

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